

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

- You aren't over-committing yourself or making your budget too complicated to manage.

All of these considerations are designed to safeguard your financial wellbeing and to make sure that you aren't creating a stressful situation for yourself that will undermine the progress you've made, but I truly believe that we need to be more realistic and accepting about the role of credit in our society and daily lives, because this system whereby it is pushed and then stigmatized is not serving anybody's wellbeing or mental health. As with everything else, the key is to make sure that any use of credit is controlled and considered.

Accepting ebb and flow

A mistake that we often make in our expectations about what wellbeing means is that we think it should be constant. We assume that we will hit some kind of golden milestone, and everything will be perfectly balanced and harmonious from there on out – or at least I did for a long time. The truth is, though, that those moments of perfect balance actually happen very rarely, and nothing is ever still. Everything about our lives is in constant motion, and we can control the direction of some of that motion through our decisions and actions, but some aspects of our lives operate entirely independently from us. The sooner we are able to accept this, and to accept that we might still have to deal with unexpected turns of events or moments of financial stress and anxiety, the better equipped